

Scandium

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There are very few ores that contain significant amounts of scandium, so it is not widely used. It is also expensive: 0.45 kg (1 lb) of scandium costs more than US\$120,000.

ATOMIC MASS 44.956

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1879 (Lars Frederik Nilson)



Laboratory
sample of
pure scandium

Titanium

This metal is as tough as steel but much lighter. Titanium can be easily refined into pure metal from its ore. It is mixed with aluminium to make superstrong alloys for aircraft bodies and engines.

ATOMIC MASS 47.867

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1791 (William Gregor)



The body of an Airbus A380 superjumbo contains about 77 tonnes of titanium.

The mineral albite, which does not contain titanium, grows alongside brookite.